

the biggest reasons behind this has been the names associated with it. VirtualBox was developed by a relatively small company (compared to its current owner) named Innatek. The company was later acquired by Sun Microsystems which in turn was bought by Oracle. Since the acquisition of Innatek by Sun, VirtualBox gained a lot of speed in development as well as acceptance by users. Its popularity only increased when Sun was acquired by Oracle. VirtualBox is a free product and there's no need to pay anything to anyone. It's licensed under GPL which means that you can have a look at the source code as well! This is one of the reasons for VirtualBox rising towards the top of the list in virtualization. Another asset by its side was being cross platform. This ensures that the software is well received by almost everyone who wants virtualization software. It runs on all the supported versions of Windows as well as on Linux and Mac OS X. Although you'd rarely find anyone using Solaris on their desktops, that too is supported! VirtualBox has plenty of features in demand by most users. But before we get into that, let's first see how to get it running.

Installation

Installing VirtualBox is easy. For Windows, as usual, you get the setup file and double-click it. Once again, admin privileges are required. For Mac OS X too, the usual install procedure would work well. For Linux, there are three ways in which you can do this:

1. Search for the VirtualBox package in your distribution's software repositories. There's a high probability that they're available. If they are, download and install them. All the required modules and dependencies are installed automatically.
2. Go to the VirtualBox web site and open the link to the page for Linux download (https://www.virtualbox.org/wiki/Linux_Downloads). Then select the right architecture and distribution for which you want to download. You can once again use `uname` – a command to find your architecture (mentioned in the VMware Workstation installation section; in case you skipped it).
3. Download the sources and compile it from scratch if everything fails. Don't forget to go through the build instructions.

VirtualBox can in fact be built (compiled) on every supported platform and the build instructions are located at https://www.virtualbox.org/wiki/Build_instructions. You'd find links to build instructions for different oper-